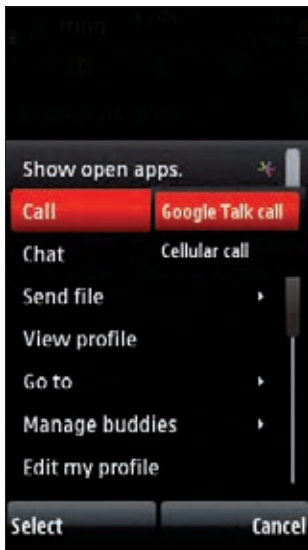


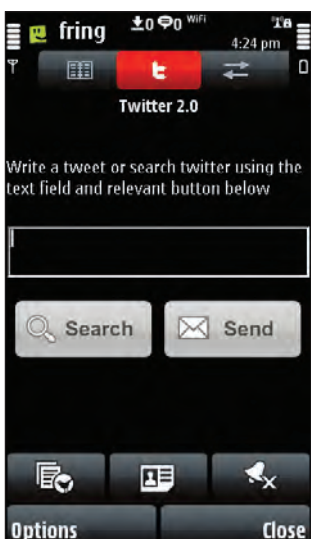


Fring lets you place a Gtalk call as well as cellular calls

your Fring account, which is like a meta account and then it connects you to your all other accounts, so it can take a while before you actually sign into Skype. Simple as it looks, it can be very annoying to open Fring every time only to find you not being able to make a Skype call.

Skype

With Skype extras, you can add functionality to your



With so much packed in, how could Twitter be left out?

bare bone installation. It is recommended to upgrade to Skype 3.0 or later version for Windows to use many of these functionalities.

Home surveillance

Sign in to your Skype account from your home computer. Set the Skype client to auto accept all incoming calls and launch the web cam functionality. Now from any remote internet enabled location, dial in to your Skype account! You have live video feed of your home. Since you wouldn't want any random person also to view your feed, switch off directory listing of your home surveillance Skype account.

Share the whiteboard

While Skype lets you chat, talk and see the other person, after installing the "WhiteBoard-Meeting" Skype extra, you can collaborate in a much more enhanced manner. This is a fully functional whiteboard where you can insert text and images and share with multiple people at the same time. You can even have multiple whiteboards. Get it at <http://www.whiteboardmeeting.com/>. In case you're interested in a very simple whiteboard, try USeeToo at <http://useetoo.com/blog>.

Record audio

You would've wished to record your communications. Be it that sweet laugh of your little niece abroad or recording the call as proof, whatever be your reason PrettyMay is the answer for all call recording solutions. This is available in three different versions including a free version (allowing a maximum duration of 15 minute per call), it offers a gamut of

features including answering machine, voicemail notification (including notification by email if you wish), on the fly MP3/WMA encoding, exporting of voice messages, recording voice memos and so on. Get it at <http://www.prettymay.net/index.htm>.

Remote troubleshooting

With Mikogo you can easily transmit your desktop to the person you are communicating with. Not only can this be used for troubleshooting or remote support, but also for various product demonstration and presentations. You can share your screen with a maximum of ten people at the same time. Get it at <https://extras.skype.com/1672>.

Share your music

You share information about the current track you're playing using players such as iTunes, WinAmp and Windows Media Player with your contact list. Get WinAmp Mood at <https://extras.skype.com/1892/view>, Windows Media Player Info at <https://extras.skype.com/2040/view>, and iTunes Info at <https://extras.skype.com/2041/view>.

Pixarra's TwistedBrush

Pixarra's TwistedBrush Open Studio is a simple lightweight designing tool for the artistically inclined. You can download it from <http://www.pixarra.com/download.html>.

Brushes are custom designed to simulate pressure and motion. If you're using an oil paint, the paint will run out soon, so you need to give exact strokes. With water colour brushes, you're painting will be smooth.

Zooming

Zooming is essential in any design / art software. In TwistedBrush, it's quite elementary. Scrolling your mouse wheel down and up, zooms in and out, respectively. On a laptop, press + and - to zoom in and out. { or [will zoom it to 100 per cent.

Choosing brushes

The brushes in TwistedBrush come with reality effects. In the brush palette, you'll find a set of predefined and easy-to-modify brushes. You can also buy more brushes. You can modify size, opacity and density from the sidebar. Another easy way to access them is to right-click on your canvas while working with the brush tool.

Choosing colour

Similarly, colour selection is done from the palette provided below the brushes. There are a series of palettes with different colours and viewing options. Check them out to see which colours you are comfortable with. Changing other features like RGB content, Hue, Saturation, Luminosity is also as simple as scrolling.

If you're unsure of how to get the colour of your choice, but you've seen it before, the colour chooser will help you get it. Again, as with the brush options, you may change colour by right-clicking the canvas. The same pop-up allows you to change colour options as well.

Brush options

The free version of TwistedBrush does not allow you to create or edit new brushes. However, while working, if you realise that there is a specific configuration you like to use